

SKOAR!

SNIPER ELITE III



Missing the mark

Anirudh Regidi
anirudh.regidi@digit.in

You've spent the last few hours scrambling through undergrowth, wading through knee deep pools of mud, picking off wandering sentries and camouflaged snipers. You haven't had time to relax, you're deep behind enemy territory and you know that your target is only 1,500m ahead. You find a nice spot, a tree that's overlooking the barracks, you carefully make your way to the top, making sure that you don't break any branches and you settle in for the long wait.

The actual shot is a calculated, controlled and exceptionally tense moment. A moment where you hold your breath, steady your heartbeat and gently pull the trigger. You hear the sharp crack of the rifle, feel the jolt of the recoil in your shoulder and get a whiff of gunpowder. The success or failure of the entire North African campaign depends on the bullet, it must not miss its mark.

The aftermath is no less satisfying, but less tense. All you see is a vague splatter of blood on a wall— you didn't miss. Soldiers are running helter-skelter, shooting randomly in your general



direction. You're not worried, you chose your spot well and none of the shots are even coming close.

This is what you'd imagine the life of a sniper is like, this is NOT Sniper Elite III. SE III is a vaguely stealthy shooter that has you "sniping" enemies from 150m and masking your shots with the put-putting of a wheezy generator, a game where you can't shoot through the flimsiest of wooden planks but can observe the shattering of bones and muscle in the minutest detail, a game where an M1 Garand is a sniper rifle and a game where enemies forget about you once a certain amount of time has passed.

The game focuses too much on the death animations, which are, to be fair, excruciatingly well-detailed and fun to watch the first dozen times or so. Sadly, they get tiresome after a while. What you really want is a more visceral sniping experience,

the ability to shoot through objects, longer range encounters, watching limbs fly.

The problem with this game is that it's too tame, the only highlights are the various death animations. There are too few occasions where you can really express your skills at sniping as most missions just boil down to finding the right spot, tagging all the enemies and picking them off one by one till they're all dead. The right spot is almost always a blindingly obvious one.

Verdict

Sniper Elite could have been so much more, the definitive sniping experience, a playground for elite snipers (and campers) but somehow, it falls short of that mark. Multiplayer is definitely a good enough reason to pick up the game, though sadly, finding a server with low enough pings is quite hard.

Should you pick up this game? Only if you're a hard-core fan of the series. For everyone else, Sniper Elite V2 still offers a much better sniping experience. *



MOAR!

Developer: Rebellion Oxford

Genre: Tactical Shooter, Stealth

Price: ₹1,499 (Windows)